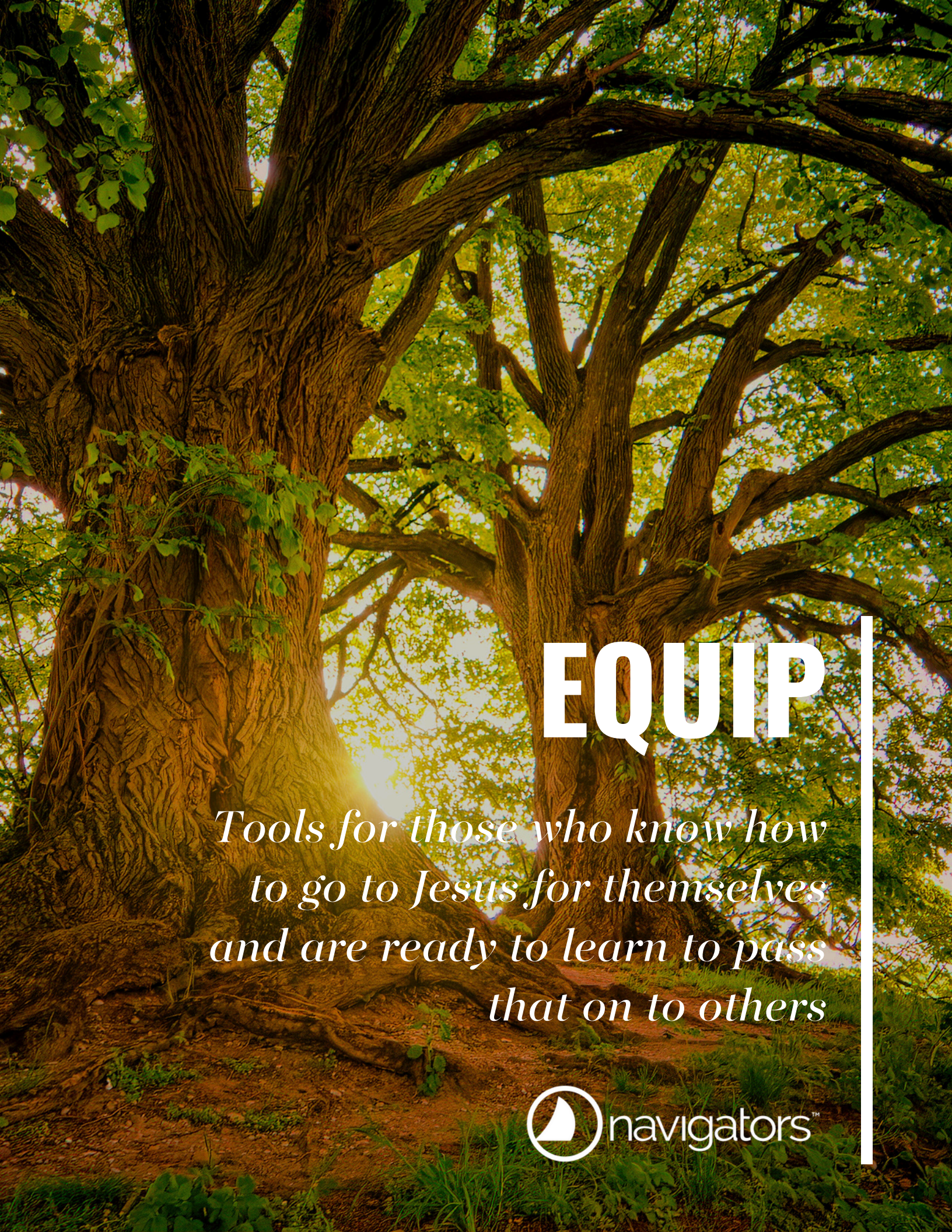
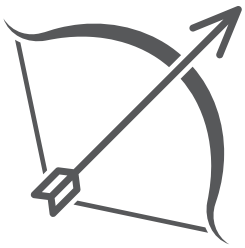


EQUIP

Tools for those who know how to go to Jesus for themselves and are ready to learn to pass that on to others

navigators™



YOU CAN MAKE DISCIPLES

Barna research lists the top five reasons Christians are not interested in being disciple makers.

1. Don't feel qualified or equipped.
2. Don't feel they would be very good at it.
3. Don't feel like they know enough about the Bible.
4. Don't feel like they know how to disciple someone.
5. Discipling someone is a job for church leaders or professional ministers.

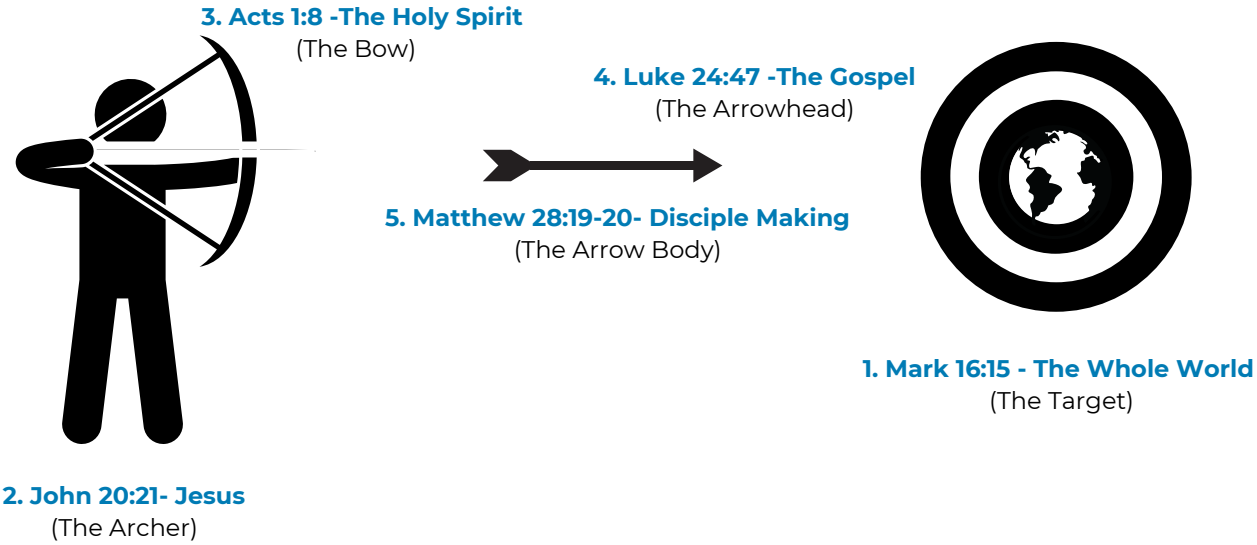
Which of these five reasons do you most identify with?

Making disciples can be intimidating. Thankfully, God has given several promises from His Word for every believer highlighting His desire to use everyday men and women to make disciples! This is illustrated below in the Archer Illustration.

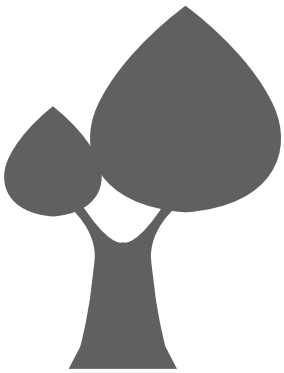
Archer Illustration

Did you know there are 5 commision passages of Jesus? Note the similarities and what makes each commission unique.

1. Mark 16:15
2. John 20:21
3. Acts 1:8
4. Luke 24:47
5. Matthew 28:19-20



Send



BORN TO REPRODUCE

"And the things you have heard me say in the presence of many witnesses entrust to reliable people who will also be qualified to teach others."
2 Timothy 2:2

Four generations are included in this verse that Paul wrote to Timothy.

1 Paul → 2 Timothy → 3 Reliable people → 4 Others

Consider the questions below:

- Why do you think Paul implored Timothy to find "reliable" people?
- What would have been the result of Timothy not finding reliable people to pass the message along to?

Born to Reproduce

In 1933, Dawson Trotman and his friends began working with sailors in the U.S. Navy. There, Dawson taught sailor Les Spencer the foundations of Christian growth. They spent many hours together praying, studying the Bible, and memorizing Scripture. When one of Spencer's shipmates asked him the secret of his changed life, Spencer brought the man to Trotman: "Teach him what you taught me," to which Dawson said, "You teach him!"

Spencer did teach the sailor, and soon the two men were meeting with others. Eventually, 125 men on their ship, the U.S.S. West Virginia, were growing in Christ and actively sharing their faith. By the end of World War II, thousands of men on ships and bases around the world were learning the principles of spiritual multiplication by the person-to-person teaching of God's word.

Spend time reading Dawson Trotman's 1955 talk Born to Reproduce and discussing the questions below:

Questions for Discussion

1. What stood out to you the most from this message?
2. What does the word "reproducer" mean to you?
3. What would help you the most right now in becoming a "reproducer?" Are there any changes you would make in your life or ministry?
4. What will you be asking God for this year?

Equip



THE NEED OF THE HOUR

"Call to me and I will answer you and tell you great and unsearchable things you do not know." Jeremiah 33:3

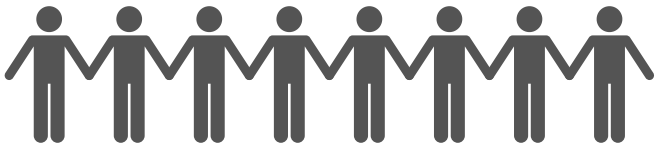
What is the greatest need of the hour in order to see God's main job of freeing an enslaved world? Is it more resources? More money? Greater justice from people and authorities? Dawson Trotman, the founder of The Navigators, speaks on Jeremiah 33:3 and addresses what he sees as the greatest need in God's Kingdom. Scan the code below to access the pdf to read and discuss.

The Need of the Hour

Questions for Reflection and Evaluation:

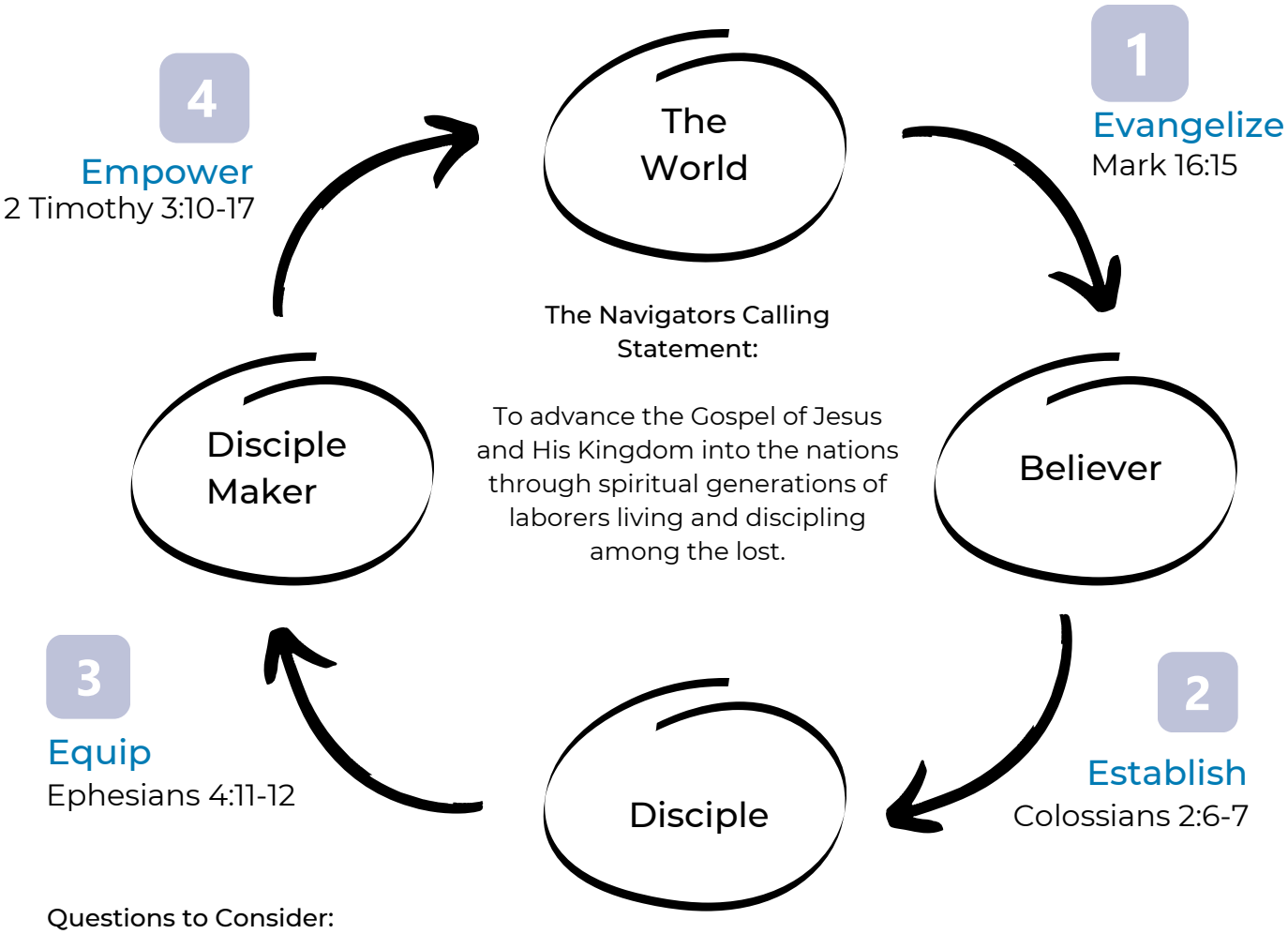
1. What often feels like the most pressing need of the hour for you as you join in God's work?
2. Thinking of your personal ministry, what things are you most tempted to rely on for the advancement of the Gospel?
3. How does this article change your understanding of how God sees the need of the hour?
4. What would it look like for you to join God in meeting this need of the hour?
5. What would it cost you?
6. What can you ask God to do in and through you this year to help meet the need of the hour?
7. We all need allies in this glorious mission. Who will you share your promises with? How will you hold each other accountable to continue to regularly pray for this?

Equip



THE DISCIPLESHIP PROCESS

Spend time reading the verses and discussing the discipleship process shown below. The purpose of this exercise is to gain a greater picture of the discipleship process, and be able to assess where an individual may be in order to best help them grow as a disciple maker! Begin by reviewing the Great Commission in Matthew 28:18-20.



Questions to Consider:

- Where are you in this process? Why would you say so?
- What is one thing you could do to grow in the stage you're in?
- What would be the result of skipping a stage in this process?
- Is there someone God is asking you to begin to disciple? Where would you say they are on this process?

Equip

JESUS AND DISCIPLESHIP

Spend time reading and making observations about the following passages. After you have discussed the passages, read through the disciplemaking principles below.

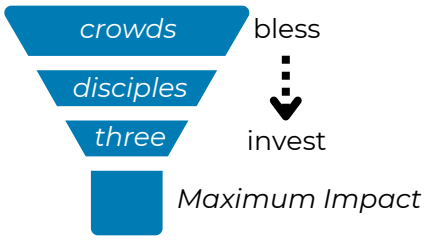
Matthew 9:35-38: *Who did Jesus minister to? What did Jesus pray for?*
And Jesus went throughout all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the gospel of the kingdom and healing every disease and every affliction. When he saw the crowds, he had compassion for them, because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd. Then he said to his disciples, "The harvest is plentiful, but the laborers are few; therefore pray earnestly to the Lord of the harvest to send out laborers into his harvest."

Luke 6:12-16: *From whom did Jesus call his disciples? What preceded this event?*
In these days he went out to the mountain to pray, and all night he continued in prayer to God. And when day came, he called his disciples and chose from them twelve, whom he named apostles: Simon, whom he named Peter, and Andrew his brother, and James and John, and Philip, and Bartholomew, and Matthew, and Thomas, and James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon who was called the Zealot, and Judas the son of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor.

Matthew 17:1-2: *Who did Jesus bring with him? Can you think of any other times Jesus singled out these three disciples?*
And after six days Jesus took with him Peter and James, and John his brother, and led them up a high mountain by themselves. And he was transfigured before them, and his face shone like the sun, and his clothes became white as light.

Disciple Making Principles:

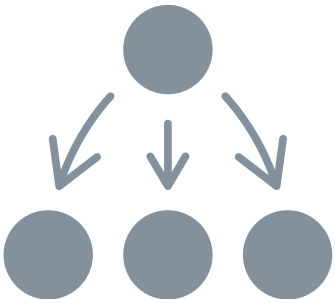
1. Jesus ministered to the crowds (Matthew 9:35-38, Luke 6:17, etc)
2. Jesus chose twelve to be with Him (Luke 6:12-16, Matthew 10:1-4, Mark 3:13-19)
3. Jesus invested heavily in the three (Matthew 17:1-2, Mark 5:37, Mark 14:33)



Principles Applied:

1. Just as Jesus spent disproportionate time with the three, so we need to spend lots of time with a few in order to help others become disciple makers.
2. Spend time with someone before jumping into a discipleship relationship with them -- get to know them without committing to anything. If you are still unsure, agree to spend 4 to 6 weeks meeting with them.
3. Pray for men and women who are FAT -- Faithful, Available and Teachable.
4. When you are ready to begin a discipleship relationship with someone you may find the following steps helpful:
   - Spend time **sharing your story** and how discipleship benefited you.
   - **Affirm** what you see in them.
   - **Cast vision** and **set expectations** for the time so that it does not simply become a glorified friendship.
   - Clearly **invite** them to be discipled by you.
   - **Establish** a time and place to meet right there!

Equip



DISCIPLESHIP 101

WHAT is Discipleship

The Greek word- mathētés translates into English as – 'disciple' or 'learner' or 'pupil'. The word disciple itself typically has two aspects to it: the relationship of a student to a teacher, and the notion of following along behind someone. First and foremost, our discipleship is to Jesus Christ, a relationship of being with him and following him (Matt 16:24-25).

In the words of John Stott: "At its simplest, Christ's call was 'Follow me.' He asked men and women for their personal allegiance. He invited them to learn from him, to obey his words and to identify themselves with his cause". In this discipleship process we are being 'transformed' so that we will eventually be 'conformed' to his likeness (Rom 8:29, 2 Cor 3:18).

The verb form 'to disciple', describes the process by which we encourage another person to be such a follower of Jesus; it means the methods we may employ to help that person to grow as a 'learner 'of Christ, to grow towards full maturity in Christ, so they may also in turn disciple someone else (i.e. that they too may become a 'disciple maker').

By using the word 'discipling', Al Stewart best describes this activity as – "more than simply evangelizing unbelievers, discipling is defined as: prayerfully and faithfully building people up until they are mature followers of the Lord Jesus (Col 1:28). Discipling is moving people forward in their knowledge of God; in their commitment to Christ; and in their commitment to serving others". In this regard, true discipleship and disciple making must rightly be understood as a process not a program.

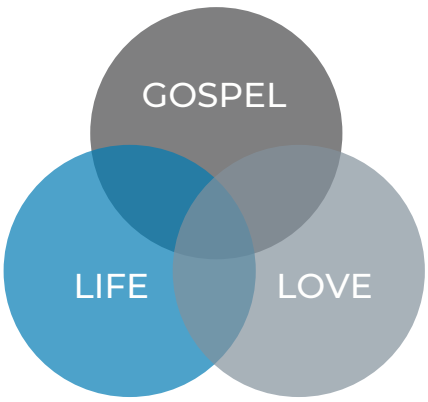
HOW do we Disciple

Because we loved you so much, we were delighted to share with you not only the gospel of God but our lives as well. - 1 Thessalonians 2:8

Discipleship involves *relationship!* It is not systematic or achieved through programs, but *life to life*. First Thessalonians 2:8 describes three areas necessary for authentic discipleship: **Life**, **Love**, and **the Gospel**.

Spend time considering what discipleship would be like if it excluded one of these three areas:

No sharing of **life** = Meaningless
No affection (**love**) of the other = Mechanical
No focus on the **Gospel** = Mentorship



DISCIPLESHIP 101

WHAT are we building

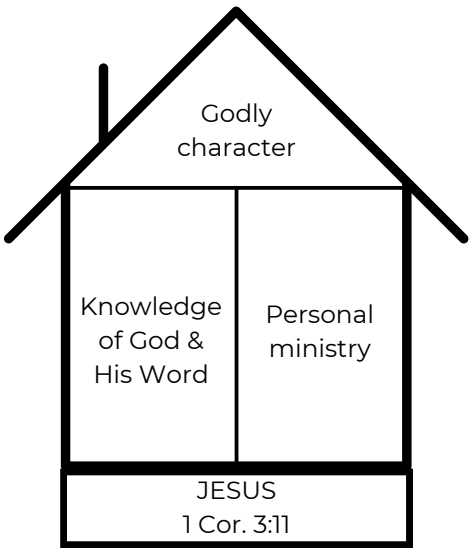
Read 1 Corinthians 3:5-11 and spend time discussing the passage.

- What is the foundation?
- Do all buildings stand the test of time?
- What might make some structures last and others burn up?

Read Romans 15:14, listed below. What is Paul desiring would be established in the life of the believer?

> *I myself am convinced, my brothers and sisters, that you yourselves are **full of goodness**, **filled with knowledge** and **competent to instruct one another**.*

A helpful illustration is a house. The foundation is Christ (1 Cor 3:11). In the verse above, Paul longs to see them be filled with knowledge of God and His Word, and able to instruct one another by understanding how to reproduce their life in another (personal ministry). This is held together by being full of goodness, which is another way to say having exemplary character.



There are many ways to disciple another. Scripture does not give us a detailed roadmap! But it does list important principles for the process.

PRINCIPLES for Discipleship

Just as Jesus spent signifiant amounts of time with Peter, James and John, so we must spend disproportional amounts of time with a few to make the greatest impact.

Paul reiterates this in 2 Timothy 2:2 when he stresses to Timothy that he is to invest in "reliable" men and women. A helpful acronym is whether they are **FAT** individuals: **Faithful, Available, and Teachable.**

Discipleship involves caring for the whole person! Consider the relationships below and how they relate to discipleship:

- **Counselor** -- While discipleship involves caring for the needs of another, it is more than simple addressing specific needs in their life! Discipleship involves being a **builder** in the life of another, not simply a **doctor** to address the current need.
- **Friend** -- Hopefully a friendship is developed between you and who you are discipling! But discipleship involves more than simply being friends; it's also helping to point them to Jesus and have an **intentional plan** to do so!
- **Mentor** -- It is difficult, if not impossible, to lead somewhere you have not gone yourself. A mentorship is where one person passes along their wisdom and expertise to another. While this may be a part of discipleship, discipleship differs from mentorship in that you are ultimately taking them to the **feet of Jesus** to learn together from God Himself, **guided by the Holy Spirit** in each of your lives!

Application: List the names of 1-3 people you might want to begin a discipleship relationship with, and begin praying God would open the door to invest in their life in this way!

Equip



MASTER BUILDER: THE WHEEL

According to the grace of God given to me, like a skilled master builder I laid a foundation, and someone else is building upon it. Let each one take care how he builds upon it.
1 Corinthians 3:10

We want to be **skilled master builders**, and build wisely into the lives of those we disciple! One of the best tools to assess where someone needs to grow is **the Wheel**. Below is a helpful plan for how to walk through the Wheel with someone you are discipling!

The Wheel

Begin with the Word to help anchor the time in Scripture.

Look up Colossians 2:6-7 and read it together. Ask "What does it mean to 'walk in Him'?"

Explain that spiritual disciplines are the means of experiencing God's grace in our lives. Share a personal example of how a spiritual discipline has helped you experience the grace of God more fully in your own life.

Draw out the wheel while explaining the hub, spokes and rim:

- All of life is found in knowing Jesus and abiding in Him [*draw Jesus as the center*].
- We communicate with God through prayer and spending time reading God's Word [*draw the vertical spokes: prayer and the Word*].
- As we interact with others, we seek to love those around us through encouraging and serving the body of Christ, and helping those who don't yet know Christ be introduced to Him [*draw the horizontal spokes: fellowship and evangelism]*.
- Our inner life reflects our outer reality, where the "rubber meets the road." Through living a life obedient to Jesus, we show the world our inner devotion to Him [*draw the rim of the wheel and write "obedience to Christ" in the rim]*.

Look up verses that talk about the center, each of the spokes, and the rim using the A-Pack of the TMS (pg 22) and discuss them together.

***For an application**, ask them to draw out the Wheel as it would look in their own life, with the lengths of the spoke showing how that spiritual discipline is reflected in their own life. Share what yours might look like. Ask if they would like to begin to grow in some of these areas together, and make a plan to meet next week to dive deeper into each topic.*

The **Establish** section of this binder is designed with tools to help someone grow in each of these areas! Next time you and your disciple meet, begin in the **Establish** section working through areas of the Wheel you both would like to grow in!

Equip



DISCIPLESHIP BLUEPRINT

Before beginning any large project it is important to keep the end in mind. No builder of a house begins building without consulting a blueprint! Similarly, it is important to keep the end in mind when discipling someone. Once you have reviewed "Discipleship 101," use this plan to help create blueprints for your discipleship time. An example is provided, with a blank copy accessible via QR code.

A helpful plan for each meeting time involves sharing **life**, the **Word**, **mission**, and **prayer** (expanded plan on pg 3). Look up the verses below as you examine those areas.

1. LIFE - *1 Thess. 2:8* 2. WORD - *Jn. 15:4-5* 3. MISSION - *Col. 1:28-29* 4. PRAYER - *Jn. 15:16*






NAME: JOE STUDENT YEAR: FRESHMAN

TOP THREE GOALS (TANGIBLE OUTCOMES) FOR THIS UPCOMING YEAR

1. Enjoy time spent in the Word each day.
2. Share the Gospel with one of their friends during this year
3. Understand God's desire for holiness, and reflect that conviction in their dating relationship, being accountable to one close friend.

	Theme	Next Steps		Theme	Next Steps
Aug	Establish	Show how to have quiet time sandwich.	Jan	Obedience	Ask to participate in a WITL study with their friend.
S	The Word	Have a Quiet Time together, show how to memorize scripture.	F	Evangelism	Invite to participate in IBD. Practice sharing the Three Circles.
O	Christ the Center	MHCH. Ask how their quiet times are going. Invite to have an extended time together.	M	Evangelism	Share the Three Circles with someone on their prayer map.
N	Nations	Begin praying for the Nations together. Create prayer map	A	Prayer	Pray for lost friends; share the Gospel with anyone who has not heard.
D	Send	Have a QT every day over break. Discuss loving family well.	M-J		

Equip



BUILDING WELL:
Values over Behaviors

PART I: Overview of Building Well
Healthy discipleship is building well into the lives of others. Spend some time reading 1 Corinthians 3:4-17 and make note of what Paul says about: **the builder, the building,** and **the building process.**

In verses 10-15 Paul makes it clear that what we build into ourselves and others matters, because fire will test the materials. Therefore we want to be building with values, not just behaviors or knowledge.

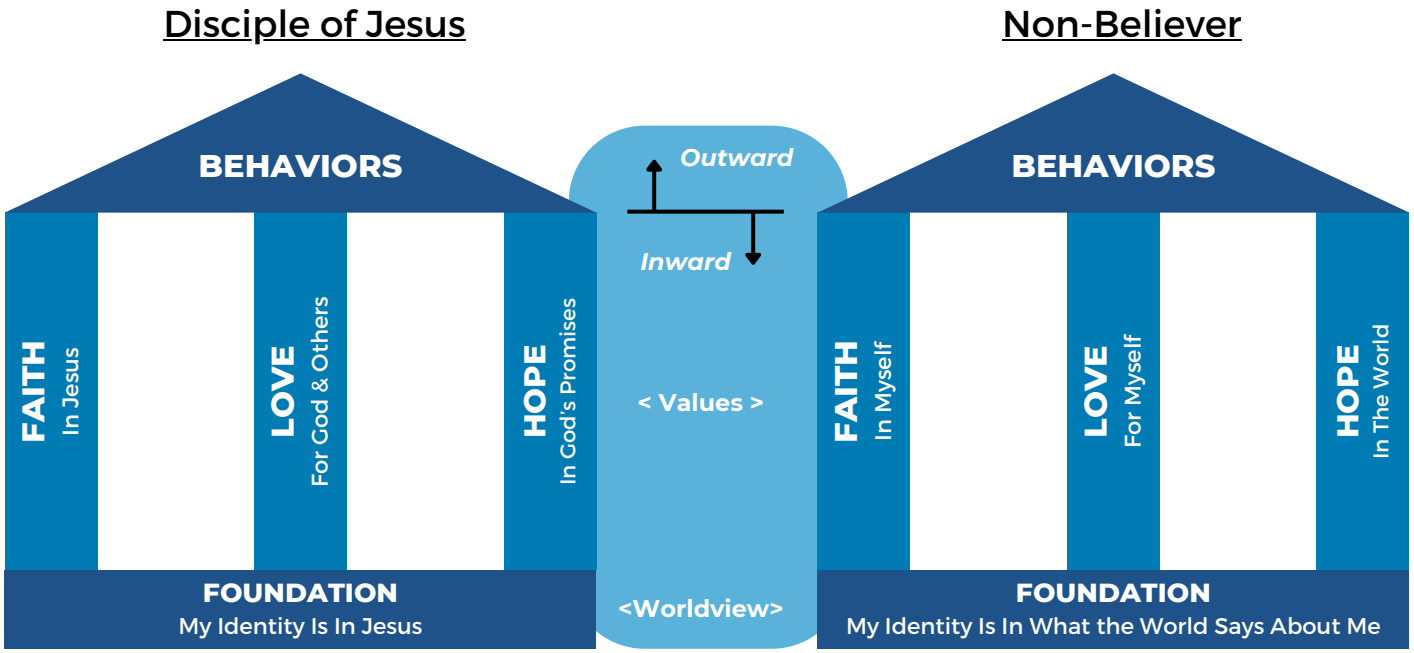
- What potential "fires" will we face in life?
- How would these two lives be different in the "fires": the one primarily built on values, and the other on behaviors and/or knowledge?

The important values repeated over and over in Paul's epistles are **faith**, **hope**, and **love**. These materials, rooted in a foundation of Jesus, are the ones that will last and that we want to be building into ourselves and others.

And now these three remain: faith, hope and love. But the greatest of these is love.
(1 Corinthians 13:13)

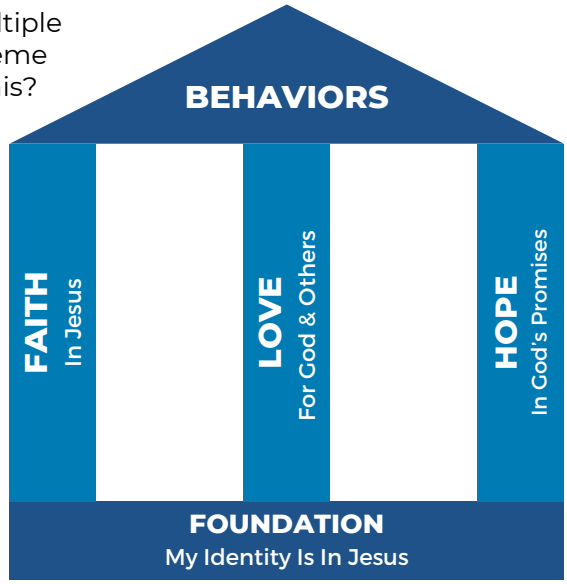
These principles are depicted by the building illustrations below, differentiating between a disciple of Jesus and a non-believer. Considering the two illustrations:

- Our Worldview (Identity) dictates our Values and our Values will dictate our Behaviors. How have you seen this to be true?
- What are the differences between the two buildings when lived out in daily life?
- Is there an area that you personally want to grow?



BUILDING WELL

Parts II-VI of this plan dive more deeply into the various elements of the building illustration. They can be done over the course of multiple meetings, but for each: (1) How does this connect to the main theme of building well? (2) How could you help someone else grow in this?



PART II: Foundation of Jesus

Read Matthew 7:24-27

- Why is it important to have a foundation on Jesus?

From John 1:1-18 and Colossians 1:13-23:

- List out the truths of Jesus
- Why is He a good foundation for our lives?
- What is our identity in light of His?

Apply: Choose a truth of Jesus that is hard to believe. Memorize and meditate on a corresponding verse, asking Jesus to help you believe it is true.

PART III: Love

Read 1 John 4:7-21:

- How is God's love described?
- How are we called to love in light of His love?

Listen to "*Love and the Practical Graces*" sermon by Timothy Keller *(can be found on YouTube.)*

- What does it look like to grow in love?

Apply: Choose one practical step to love God or someone else this week. Ask someone to join you!

PART IV: Faith

How would you define faith? List out 5-10 verses that talk about faith and read them together.

Read Hebrews 11:1-16 (Hall of Faith)

- Based on this, what marks a life of faith?

Apply: Choose a spiritual discipline you enjoy. How has it helped you grow in faith? Practice sharing it through the lens of growing in faith!

PART V: Hope

Read Romans 8:18-30

- Make observations about hope
- What are we hoping for and in?

Hebrews 6:19 calls hope "*an anchor for the soul*"

- Why is hope important? What anchors your soul?

Apply: Choose a promise of God to hope for. Is there someone else who needs to hear this too?

PART VI: Persevering in Love, Faith, and Hope

Read Hebrews 10:19-25

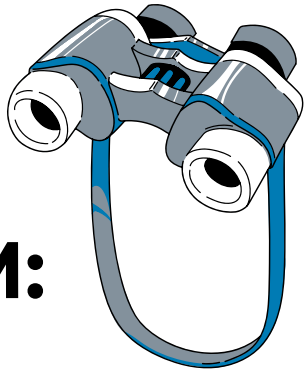
- What does it say about...
  - Foundation in Christ (19-22)?
  - Love (24-25)?
  - Faith (22)?
  - Hope (23)?
- Why is perseverance needed to live these out?

Summarize what you've learned in Parts I-VI in 1-3 sentences. How should this impact disciple making?

Apply: What would your life look like in 5, 10, 20 years if you persevered in each of thee areas? What is one choice you can make today to help you persevere for a lifetime?

**Optional Study: Read each of the epistles and note the uses of faith, hope, and love (highlight, box, circle, etc). Further study the passages that use all three: (1) What do you learn about each of them? (2) How do they interconnect? (3) What context are they being used in?*

Equip



RELATIONAL EVANGELISM: P.A.L.S.

When Jesus called his disciples, it was not an invitation to "do" evangelism, but to "be" evangelists; in fact all areas of their lives would change to walk the same path as their teacher.

"And He said to them, "Follow Me [as My disciples, accepting Me as your Master and Teacher and walking the same path of life that I walk], and I will make you fishers of men." Matthew 4:19 [AMP]

Although the word "evangelism" can be intimidating, when we examine Jesus' life, it is as simple as obeying the Father courageously in the regular rhythms of life.

Here are 4 rhythms to live out of our identity as children while we courageously and lovingly live out our calling as evangelists.

PURSUE HOLINESS

Heb. 12:14, Matt. 5:14-16

- Be someone who enjoys Jesus and lives out of the "freedom" of their design (who we are AND who we pursue to be)
- The people around us need us to be more holy than relevant

ACTIVE PRAYER LIST

Matt. 9:36-38, Jn. 15:7

- Be someone who aligns their heart with Jesus regularly and believes him by faith
- Pray Promises, Pray for Souls

LOOK FOR OPPORTUNITIES

Eph. 2:10, Jn. 4:34-38

- See ourselves as Christ's masterpieces, ambassadors of the good news we have received, and that we were created for good things prepared beforehand

SALTY CONVERSATIONS

Col. 4:5-6, Matt. 10:16

- Be someone who is curious like Jesus and ask courageously
- Remember FORT (Family, Occupation, Recreation, Testimony)

Equip



GOSPEL FLUENCY

What makes someone fluent in a language? How about fluent in the gospel?

How natural is it for your to relate the gospel to your own day-to-day life? Why?

A basic rule of communication is that we are to communicate with others in a way *they* best understand. When sharing the gospel, this often requires us to step out of our natural way of relating in order to meet someone else where they currently are in their understanding of the gospel, rather than where *we* might be in our understanding, or how *we* would like to be communicated with.

Consider the definitions and tool below. Fill out the practice example, then complete an example of your own from an encounter you had this past week!

EXPERIENCE: A specific event or feeling you've had recently. Could span a moment or months.

CONCEPT/WORD: An idea or theme from the gospel / God's Word that is especially good news to you right now in response to that experience. This helps anchor our thinking and experience and narrows it into something specific that can be shared. We grow to interpret our lives through the gospel, not the other way around.

VERSE: Ground that concept/word in the Scriptures by relating it to a verse that God has used in your life (or explains the concept/word well). This also helps subtly introduce God's Word and reveals our daily dependence on it. Hearing you quote Scripture becomes normal to your non-believing friends.

QUESTION: Open up the conversation to your friend or community. This gives the listener a chance to respond and gives you an easy way to discuss the Word.

CONCEPTS FOUND IN THE GOSPEL:

Grace, peace, love, hope, faith, forgiveness, freedom, healing, restoration, reconciliation, redemption, purification, belonging, intimacy, joy, newness, fully known, reborn, understood, tenderness, Father, fullness, complete, pursuit, family, fellowship (with God and people), security, purpose

EXAMPLE: Recently when I've been feeling down on myself for "not doing enough," whether that be in work or pursuing friends while I've been home for Christmas time. God has been reminding me of how gentle he is to me even though I'm weak and inconsistent. There's a cool verse in the Bible that talks about how Jesus "sympathizes with our weaknesses" because he experienced the same trials and temptations as us when he lived on earth. The next verse says that we should draw near to God with confidence so that we can receive mercy and grace when we're in need. So, I've been thanking God that he understands why I'm frustrated and even more so that he wants me to go to him for help. Do you feel like Jesus understands you? / Would you want to see those verses I was talking about? What do you think about them?

EXPERIENCE	CONCEPT/WORD	VERSE	QUESTION
Feeling forgotten by friends, but remembering that God seeks me out constantly	God's pursuit	Isaiah 62:12 "...you shall be called Sought Out, a City Not Forsaken"	Do you think God is pursuing you? /Do you want to see that verse I was talking about?

EXTENDED TIME WITH THE FATHER

In a marriage, it is important to prioritize healthy rhythms in the midst of the busyness of life. These often include a daily touch point, a weekly date night, and a monthly/quarterly extended time together.

So in our union with Christ, it is important to develop healthy rhythms in the midst of the noise around us to hear from our savior. In addition to daily time with God, a helpful rhythm is an extended time away together.

And he said to them, "Come away by yourselves to a desolate place and rest a while." For many were coming and going, and they had no leisure even to eat.
Mark 6:31

Consider the verse above. To what were the disciples invited into? What were they invited away from?

WHAT is an extended time with the Father

There is no right way to have an extended time away with the Father, nor set amount of time required. For some this may mean stretching yourself to spend two hours with God. For others it might look like a morning, an entire day, or a weekend.

Lorne Sanny, former president of The Navigators, once said:
"The result of your day in prayer should be answers to the two questions Paul asked the Lord on the Damascus road (Acts 22:6-10). Paul's first question was, 'Who are you, Lord?' The Lord replied, 'I am Jesus.' You will be seeking to know Him, to find out who He is. The second question Paul asked was, 'What shall I do, Lord?' and the Lord answered him specifically. This should be answered or reconfirmed for you in that part of the day when you unhurriedly seek His will for you."

HOW to spend an extended time with the Father

Pastor and teacher John Mark Comer once remarked that our lives can feel like water in a pitcher, sloshing around when moved. Once the pitcher is placed steady on a table it will take the water some time to settle. This is often true of our lives in an ever more hurried culture.

Begin your time settling your heart. This may involve going for a walk, journaling, praying (silently, out loud as you walk, or with a friend), singing hymns or reflecting on a Psalm. The goal of this time is to answer the question: How am I doing?

After some time, it will likely be helpful to go to Scripture. Consider reading through an entire epistle, a section of scripture, or reviewing verses you have found meaningful. Prayerfully consider who the Lord is and what He might have to say to you through the time.

EXTENDED TIME WITH THE FATHER

Everyone is different. Some may prefer a plan, others prefer the freedom to approach the Word unhurried. Some may like to sing or reflect who God is through nature, others may want to spend time studying in-depth a passage of scripture. Whatever the case, keep the focus of the time on knowing God and hearing from Him.

Use the QR code if you're looking for a framework to use.

BEST PRACTICES for spending extended time with the Father.

- **TIMING:** This time never simply "appears" - it must be intentionally created and rigorously guarded. Consider scheduling this with a like-minded friend so you both can stay accountable.

- **RHYTHMS:** While this practice may be particularly helpful when facing an important decision, it is helpful to develop this discipline as a regular rhythm in our lives! Consider blocking out time weekly or monthly. Many have found it helpful to spend a weekend away with the Lord annually. Consider fasting during this time to remember how the Lord sustains you!

- **DISTRACTIONS:** It is only natural for distractions to arise! Keep a piece of paper close by to write down any tasks that come to mind that you might need to attend to later. Resist the temptation to work on something that comes up. Write it down and move on, knowing you can address it later. Consider silencing or even turning off your phone and electronics for this time.

- **WHAT TO TAKE:** Consider bringing noise canceling headphones, a pen and your journal, your Bible, any sermon or workshop notes you would like to review, verses you have been memorizing or meditating on, and possibly a devotional book. It may be helpful to bring old journals to review during this time.

- **STAY ALERT:** Be sure to get a good night sleep before setting out on this time. If spending all day or multiple days with the Lord, take breaks every so often to go for a walk, or go somewhere you can talk out loud. Give variety in what you do -- pray, journal, spend time in Scripture, etc.

- **KEEP THE MAIN THING THE MAIN THING:** The purpose of a date with a loved one is not to try out a new restaurant or see the movie you've been wanting to see; it is to spend time together with the someone you love. So it is with the Lord during this time. The primary goal is to spend time with the Father. Enjoy hearing from Him what He longs to say to you!

He says, "Be still, and know that I am God; I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth."
Psalm 46:10

Equip



PRAYING THE PROMISES: PLEADING WITH GOD

Be strong and courageous. In times of distress turn to God in prayer and ask Him to fulfill His promises to His people. To see the following principles applied, read Daniel 9:1-19.

ATTITUDE OF HUMILITY AND EXPECTANCY

We come with a twofold attitude of both abject humility and courageous expectancy. We don't dictate to God, even when claiming His promises. But we do come boldly, reverentially before His throne.

ACKNOWLEDGE AND CONFESS SIN

We come before God acknowledging our sinfulness and confessing our sins as the Holy Spirit brings them to remembrance. We must not deceive ourselves into thinking that the Lord will honor our requests if we harbor unconfessed sin in our lives or if we are living in a condition of disobedience to His revealed will in the Bible.

BRING SPECIFIC CONCERNS AND DETAILS TO GOD

It is not that the omniscient Lord needs more information; rather in doing this, our thoughts clarify, and the Lord can help us better understand and gain perspective on our current situation.

FOCUS ON GOD'S CHARACTER

It is good to remind the Lord of certain related character qualities, not only pleading that He act in keeping with His character, but also asking Him to build these into our lives during this testing of our faith.

BASE OUR REQUESTS ON THE PROMISES IN GOD'S WORD

Though we do make specific requests, we again must yield to the Lord the right to answer in His way and in His time. He alone can see all things; He knows what circumstances and timing are best for us. Having a demanding spirit regarding either the means or the time of God's answer is a sign of spiritual immaturity.

PRAYING THE PROMISES: PLEADING WITH GOD

PROMISES TO DEPEND ON FROM GOD'S WORD REGARDING HIS LOVE AND CARE FOR YOU.

PSALM 103:17
But from everlasting to everlasting the Lord's love is with those who fear him, and his righteousness with their children's children.

NAHUM 1:7
The Lord is good, a refuge in times of trouble. He cares for those who trust in him.

MATTHEW 6:31-33
So do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the pagans run after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well.

MATTHEW 10:29-31
Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground outside your Father's care. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So don't be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.

JOHN 14:21
Whoever has my commands and keeps them is the one who loves me. The one who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I too will love them and show myself to them.

JOHN 15:9,10
As the Father has loved me, so have I loved you. Now remain in my love. If you keep my commands, you will remain in my love, just as I have kept my Father's commands and remain in his love.

ROMANS 8:32
He who did not spare his own Son, but gave him up for us all—how will he not also, along with him, graciously give us all things?

1 PETER 5:7
Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you.

For a list of promises related to specific topics, scan the QR code

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/pleading
Adapted from Praying Over God's Promises, *by Tom Yeakley, used with permission of NavPress.*

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YOUR PLACE IN MISSIONS

A Concise World Vision Bible Study

PART I: Meditate on the following verses and list one fresh insight from each on God's heart for all nations. Then note 1-2 overall themes that stand out to you.

- Genesis 12:1-3
- Genesis 22:15-18
- 2 Samuel 14:14
- Isaiah 43:3-7
- Isaiah 49:6
- Isaiah 60:22
- Matthew 9:35-38
- Matthew 28:18-20
- Mark 16:15
- Luke 19:10
- Luke 24:44-48
- John 4:35
- John 20:21-23
- Acts 1:8
- Revelation 7:9-10

PART II: Read Isaiah 6, and note God giving Isaiah a vision of His glory, a vision of Isaiah's brokenness, and a vision of the world's need.

A. Do you think all 3 visions are critical for missions? Why? And why might there be significance to their occurring in this sequence?

B. Why do you think God asks for volunteers after the second vision, instead of after the first or third?

PART III: What is the warning for going into missions in Jeremiah 12:5?

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